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MAY/JUNE 2008

CARIBBEAN EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL

**SECONDARY EDUCATION CERTIFICATE
EXAMINATION**

ENGLISH B

Paper 01 – General Proficiency

1½ hours

14 MAY 2008 (p.m.)

In addition to the 1½ hours allowed for the examination,
you are allowed 15 minutes in order to read through the
entire paper.

You may write during the 15-minute period.

ANSWER ALL QUESTIONS IN THIS PAPER.

Each question is worth 15 marks.

DO NOT TURN THIS PAGE UNTIL YOU ARE TOLD TO DO SO.

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ANSWER ALL QUESTIONS IN THIS PAPER.

SECTION A – DRAMA

1. Read the following extract carefully and answer ALL the questions that follow.

AT CURTAIN

Three o'clock of an afternoon. The saloon is deserted. The central floor area is cleared and a small rostrum, decorated with flags and coloured kerchiefs, stands at one end. In the rostrum is a richly-ornamented tinsel crown on a stand. The noise of drumming and chanting in the distance.

TIM BRISCOE enters the saloon and sits. He is a clean-shaven, youthful looking blade about 20, dressed inconspicuously in open-necked shirt and khaki pants, tennis shoes and with a kerchief tied round his neck. He calls to the barman.

BRISCOE: Swifty! A drink! Swifty!

(No answer. He crosses to the bar and pours himself a drink. Then he turns to inspect the decorations, takes up the crown, tries it on, looks at himself in a piece of glass.)

BRISCOE: Jeezu-web! A natural fit!

(He finds a poui-stick and begins to go through the motions of a stick-fighter in the ring. Not satisfied with his display, he takes a long drink, changes his own neckerchief for a gaudy one from the rostrum, assumes a fierce expression, looks in the mirror again and, apparently satisfied, he shadows with the stick once more, this time going through the pantomime more ferociously. Carried away, he emits a shrill yell which brings PORTAGEE JOE hurrying out from the back of the store.)

JOE: What the hell . . . hey, who you be!

(Briscoe stops, embarrassed. He puts down the crown and poui-stick, and returns the kerchief he had borrowed.)

Ah, Senor Briscoe!

BRISCOE: The shop was empty.

JOE: Swifty not here?

BRISCOE: Nor Inez either.

JOE: She in the tent, but where he disappear?

BRISCOE: You expecting him to miss the fight?

JOE: Don't I employ him and have the right To say if he can go?

- BRISCOE: In Trinidad
A stick-fight send everybody mad.
- 35 JOE: Excepting you? I think the whole village
Down in the tent to witness a barrage
Of blows. Say how come you exclude
Yourself from all that?
- BRISCOE: I ain't in the mood.
- 40 JOE: You grieving still over Petite Belle Lily.
Forget her, my friend, that is a frisky
Girl who looking fame, not romance,
All you can offer is perseverance.
Tell me you know how to fight stick at all?
- 45 BRISCOE: It run in my blood. You ever hear tell
of the great Moscobee? He was my poopa
And teach me all the science of war
From the time I could walk.
- JOE: That is bygone days.
I, too, was famous for all kind of crazy
50 Things. But reason take over now.
- BRISCOE: To win Petite Belle I could recall how
To braix and charge —
- JOE: I wouldn't start
Up again, Briscoe boy. Console your heart
55 That it have plenty fish in the sea.
So one get away, that is no tragedy.
- BRISCOE: You taking a drink?
- JOE: Pass me over this one.
- BRISCOE: I notice you make big preparation
60 To crown the champion.

Errol Hill, "Man Better Man". Plays for Today, Longman, 1985, pp. 146 - 147.

- (a) Who would normally be in the shop? (3 marks)
- (b) What was the relationship between Briscoe and Petite Belle Lily? (2 marks)
- (c) (i) What specifically is Briscoe referring to in lines 59 – 60 of the episode?
- (ii) Give TWO pieces of evidence to support your answer in (i) above. (4 marks)
- (d) (i) Identify TWO examples of dramatic techniques used in this episode.
- (ii) Comment on the effectiveness of EACH of the techniques identified in (i) above. (6 marks)

Total 15 marks

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE

SECTION B – POETRY

2. Read the following poem carefully and answer ALL the questions that follow.

Massa Day Done

Viv* in a mood today, you only have to watch,
 see the jaw grinding, he stabbing the pitch, back-lift big.
 Look how he stare down the wicket, spear in he eye,
 he going to start sudden, violent, a thunder shock.
 5 Man, this could be an innings! This could make life good.

You see how he coming in, how he shoulder relax,
 how he spin he bat, how he look up at the sun,
 how he seem to breathe deep, how he swing the bat, swing,
 how he look around like a lord, how he chest expan'.
 10 You ever see the man wear helmet? Tell me?
 They say he too proud an' foolish.
 Nah! He know he worth, boy;
 the bowler should wear helmet, not he.
 Remember long this day, holy to be here.
 15 See him stalk the high altar o' the mornin' air.

You ever see such mastery in this world?
 You ever see a man who dominate so?
 This man don't know forbearance,
 he don't know surrender or forgive,
 20 he lash the ball like something anger him.
 Look how the man torment today!
 He holding the bat, it could be a axe.
 Look how he grinding he jaw again, boy,
 how he head hold cock an' high
 25 and he smile, he gleam, like a jaguar.
 Don't bring no flighty finery here; it gone!
 Bring the mightiest man, Viv husk he.
 He always so, he stay best fo' the best.

I tell you, he smile like he hungry;
 30 you ever see this man caress?
 That mood hold he, it bite he!
 He pound the ball, look at that, aha!
 Like he vex, he slash, he pull, he hook,
 he blast a way through the cover, man,
 35 he hoist the ball like cannon ball
 Gone far and wild, scattering the enemy,
 and foe turn tremble, danger all about.
 It's butchery today; bat spill blood
 and he cut like he cutting hog on a block;
 40 nobody could stop he in that mood.

Almighty love be there! Almighty love, boy.
We know from the start, he one o' we.
Something hurt he bad, you could see,
as if heself alone could end we slavery!

* Sir Vivian Richards – a former West Indian cricket captain

*Ian McDonald, Between Silence and Silence,
Peepal Tree, 2003, pp. 87 - 88.*

- (a) State TWO reasons why the use of Creole* is effective in this poem. (2 marks)
- (b) Identify TWO similes in the poem. For EACH simile identified, comment on its effectiveness. (6 marks)
- (c) What do the words 'holy' and 'high altar' suggest about Viv's function? (3 marks)
- (d)
 - (i) For whom or for what does Viv display 'Almighty love'?
 - (ii) How does he demonstrate his love? (2 marks)
- (e) Comment on the appropriateness of the title. (2 marks)

Total 15 marks

* Same as Creolese

SECTION C – PROSE FICTION

3. Read the following extract carefully and answer ALL the questions that follow.

5 The inside of the doctor's house astonished Lily. The floor of the large, airy living room was bare - dark, polished wooden boards. French windows looked out onto a long, unkempt garden. Half-way down the room was a baby grand piano, and in the corner stood a display cabinet full of red, black and gold-patterned chinaware. There were no ornaments on the mantelpiece. There were no curtains at the windows. The only furniture in the room was a down-at-heel settee and an ancient ungainly armchair. Lily stood in the centre of the room. The spaciousness of it made her feel agoraphobic. The room was too full of light. She became self-conscious. Her recent visitor leaned with her back to the fireplace, heels resting on the fireguard. Lily noticed that she wore plimsolls. But they must have money, thought Lily. It all seemed peculiar. She had thought there would be carpets.

15 Perched on the edge of the settee was another woman, a woman who seemed altogether a more suitable occupant for a doctor's house. Mrs. Parrish. Mrs. Parrish stirred a cup of tea with a small silver spoon. Immediately, Lily was reminded of the Duchess of Windsor. Her silhouette was etched sharply against the light from the French windows. On her head was a neat, black hat with a spotted veil. Protruding from one side of the hat was a piece of stiffened felt the shape of a crow's tail feathers. Immaculate was the word that came to Lily's mind as they were introduced.

'Does your husband have his surgery in this house?' Lily enquired politely.

20 'Oh, I'm the doctor,' laughed the woman, still in her brown raincoat.

Lily suffered an attack of violent social vertigo. What a blunder. But how on earth was she supposed to know? - the blasted woman dressed as though she kept chickens. The colour rose in Lily's cheeks. Dr. Bartholomew as she had turned out to be, appeared not to notice.

25 'In fact, Mrs. Parrish's husband and I were medical students together. He has a surgery further up the hill. I work in the Public Health Department.'

'How nice it must be to have brains,' stammered Lily.

Mrs. Parrish had turned her head and was smiling at her. Her cheeks were puffy. For a second she reminded Lily of a python.

*Pauline Melville, "About That Two Pounds, Mrs. Parrish".
Shape-shifter Stories, The Women's Press, 1990, pp. 77 - 78.*

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE

- (a) What TWO aspects of Lily's character are conveyed by the wrong assumptions she makes? (4 marks)
- (b) Outline TWO impressions of Dr Bartholomew's character and personality. Support your answer with evidence from the passage. (6 marks)
- (c) What does the writer achieve by saying that Mrs. Parrish momentarily 'reminded Lily of a python' (line 29)? (2 marks)
- (d) Give ONE example of humour from the passage. (1 mark)
- (e) Outline ONE theme that this passage explores. (2 marks)

Total 15 marks**END OF TEST**

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